

ETHICS REVIEW CHECKLIST FOR RESEARCH – CENTRAL REAG

A checklist should be completed for every research project in order to identify whether a full application for ethics approval needs to be submitted. The chief investigator or, where the chief investigator is a student, the supervisor, is responsible for exercising appropriate professional judgement in this review.

This checklist must be completed before potential participants are approached to take part in any research. All forms must be signed by the School's Research Ethics Advisory Group representative.

Section I: Project details

Project title:	London Underground "What-If" Simulation — User Study (COMP6030 Group Project, Group PG6)		
Planned start date: 14/05/2026	Planned end date: 25/05/2026		
Funder:	N/A — unfunded undergraduate final-year project		

Section II: Applicant details

Applicant name:	Sinead Parkinson (Project Manager) — on behalf of group PG6: Jaden Toon, Sattyaj Paul, Saf Sikder		
School/Department:	School of Computing, University of Kent		
Email:	sop3@kent.ac.uk		
☒ Undergraduate	☐ Taught Postgraduate	☐ Research Postgraduate	☐ Staff

Section III: Declaration and signatures

Please note that as Chief Investigator it is your responsibility to follow, and to ensure that all researchers involved with your project follow, accepted ethical practice and appropriate professional ethical guidelines in the conduct of your study. You must take all reasonable steps to protect the dignity, rights, safety and well-being of participants. This includes providing participants with appropriate information sheets, ensuring informed consent and ensuring confidentiality in the storage and use of data. In signing this form you are

Applicant signature:		Date:	02.06.26
Supervisor name:	Peter Rodgers	Date:	
Supervisor signature:			

School REAG Rep. signature: (required for both staff and students)		Date:	
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If all questions in the checklist are answered as ‘no’, send the completed and signed form to the Central REAG along with a full proposal and other supporting documentation.

If any question in Section IV(A) are answered ‘yes’, you may need approval from an external body. Contact the Senior Research Ethics & Governance Officer for advice and assistance with this process.

Once ethical approval is granted by the external body, a copy must be sent to the Central REAG.

If any questions in Section IV(B), IV(C) or IV(D) are answered ‘yes’, you will need to complete the full application form and send it to the Central REAG for review by the Research Ethics Advisory Group (REAG) along with a copy of the project protocol and any supporting documentation such as participant information sheets and consent forms.

Any significant change in the question, design or conduct over the course of the research should be notified to the REAG Chair and may require a new application for ethics review.

Section IV: Research Checklist

Please answer all questions by ticking the appropriate box:

A) Research that may need to be reviewed by an NHS Research Ethics Committee, the Social Care Research Ethics Committee (SCREC) or other external ethics committee (if yes, please give brief details as an annex)	YES	NO
Will the study involve recruitment of patients through the NHS or the use of NHS patient data or samples?		X
Will the study involve the collection of tissue or other biological samples (including blood, saliva, urine, etc.) from participants or the use of existing samples?		X
Will the study involve participants, or their data, from adult social care, including home care, or residents from a residential or nursing care home?		X
Will the study involve research participants identified because of their status as relatives or carers of past or present users of these services?		X
Does the study involve participants aged 16 or over who are unable to give informed consent? (e.g. people with certain learning disabilities or dementia)		X
Is the research a social care study funded by the Department of Health?		X
Is the research a health-related study involving prisoners?		X
Is the research a clinical investigation of a non-CE Marked medical device, or a medical device which has been modified or is being used outside its CE Mark intended purpose, conducted by or with the support of the manufacturer or another commercial company to provide data for CE marking purposes? (a CE mark signifies compliance with European safety standards)		X
Is the research a clinical trial of an investigational medicinal product or a medical device?		X

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If the answer to any questions in Section IV A is 'yes', please contact the Senior Research Ethics & Governance Officer for further advice and assistance.

B) Research that may need full review by the Central REAG	YES	NO
Does the research involve other vulnerable groups: children; those with cognitive impairment?		X
Is the research to be conducted in such a way that the relationship between participant and researcher is unequal (e.g. a subject may feel under pressure to participate in order to avoid damaging a relationship with the researcher)?		X
Does the project involve the collection of material that could be considered of a sensitive, personal, biographical, medical, psychological, social or physiological nature?		X
Will the study require the cooperation of a gatekeeper for initial access to the groups or individuals to be recruited? (e.g. students at school; members of a self-help group?)		X
Will it be necessary for participants to take part in the study without their knowledge and consent at the time? (e.g. covert observation of people in non-public places?)		X
Will the study involve discussion of sensitive topics (e.g. sexual activity; drug use; criminal activity?)		X
Are drugs, placebos or other substances (e.g. food substances, vitamins) to be administered to the study participants or will the study involve invasive, intrusive or potentially harmful procedures of any kind?		X
Is pain or more than mild discomfort likely to result from the study?		X
Could the study induce psychological stress or anxiety or cause harm or negative consequences beyond the risks encountered in normal life?		X
Will the study involve prolonged or repetitive testing?		X
Will the research involve administrative or secure data that requires permission from the appropriate authorities before use?		X
Is there a possibility that the safety of the researcher may be in question (e.g. international research; locally employed research assistants)?		X
Does the research involve participants carrying out any of the research activities themselves (i.e. acting as researchers as opposed to just being participants)?		X
Will the research take place outside the UK? (You may find the University of Kent guidance on risk management for travelling, working and studying useful.)		X
Will the outcome of the research allow respondents to be identified either directly or indirectly (e.g. through aggregating separate data sources gathered from the internet)?		X
Will the research involve the sharing of data or confidential information beyond the initial consent given?		X
Is there a possibility that identities of individuals could be revealed from combining anonymous datasets with other online or offline sources?		X
Will financial inducements (other than reasonable expenses and compensation for time) be offered to participants?		X

Are there any conflicts of interest with the proposed research/research findings? (e.g., is the researcher working for the organisation under research or might the research or research findings cause a risk of harm to the participants(s) or the researcher(s) or the institution?)		X
Will the study involve the publication, sharing or potentially insecure electronic storage and/or transfer of data that might allow identification of individuals, either directly or indirectly? (e.g. publication of verbatim quotations from an online forum; sharing of audio/visual recordings; insecure transfer of personal data such as addresses, telephone numbers etc.; collecting identifiable personal data on unprotected** internet sites.) ** Check University of Kent recommended software: https://kent.kent.ac.uk/		X

C) Security Sensitive Material	YES	NO
Does your research involve access to or use of material covered by the Terrorism Act? (The Terrorism Act (2006) outlaws the dissemination of records, statements and other documents that can be interpreted as promoting and endorsing terrorist acts. By answering 'yes' you are registering your legitimate use of this material with the Research Ethics Advisory Group. In the event of a police investigation, this registration will help you to demonstrate that your use of this material is legitimate and lawful).		X

D) Prevent Agenda	YES	NO
Does the research have the potential to radicalise people who are vulnerable to supporting terrorism or becoming terrorists themselves?		X

If the answer to any questions in Sections IV(B) and/or IV(C) and/or IV(D) is 'yes', please complete the full application form and send to the Central REAG: centralresearchethics@kent.ac.uk together with required supporting documentation.